through life. But focusing on growing your income by adding value to others *and* saving a large portion of that income gives you an opportunity to achieve FI quickly, making future work optional.

Career compounding is bound by the same variables that govern all investment growth. The goal for those *Choosing FI* is to shorten the number of years we *have* to work. So we have to focus on the other two variables.

1. How can you increase the principal (i.e., the amount earned)?
2. How can you increase the rate of return on your investment (i.e., the growth of your income)?

A common pattern among those who achieve FI quickly is to choose a career that commands an above-average income. It’s popular to say you should “follow your passion.” Others might say, “find a job you love, and you’ll never work a day in your life.” Those make great bumper stickers, but they don’t typically work well in the real world. Maybe a better idea is to find a career that interests you and allows you to earn a solid income. Then learn to love it, or at least like it, while saving a high percentage of your income, allowing you to achieve FI quickly.